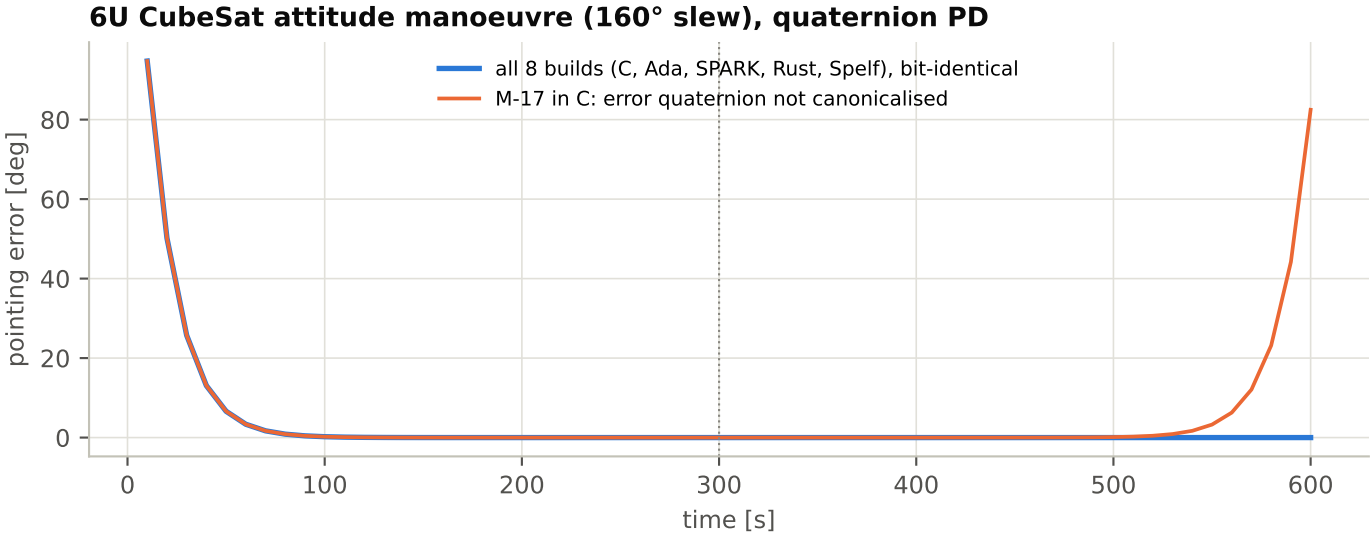estimator flips q → −q